WONDER DAILY

Fingerprints Up Close

A hidden print

Tiny ridges carry sweat and oil. A touch copies their pattern, even when you cannot see it.

Three patterns

Loops curve back. Whorls make circles. Arches flow across with a bump. No two have ever been found to match.

Made before birth

Prints form before birth. Each fingertip grows in its own tiny way, so even twins differ.

Koala prints

Koalas and people both grip things. Scientists think ridges may help us feel fine textures.

A safe print lift

Detective tools are for trained lab workers. A pencil patch and clear tape make a safe print.

Wrinkly fingers

Nerves make bath fingers wrinkle. Maybe wrinkles help grip wet things. Scientists are still checking.

Make a little book

1 Fold it into 8 boxes. Open it flat.

2 Fold short end to short end. Cut the thick line. Open it.

3 Fold the long way, pictures out. Push the ends in.

4 Fold into a book. Page 1 goes on the front!